

Working Backwards - Instructions For Writing Press Release

Press release

Heading

*Name the product in a way the reader (i.e. your target customers) will understand.
(Short name)*

Insert_text_here

Subheading

*Describe the customer for the product and what benefits they will gain from using it.
(One sentence only underneath the Heading)*

Insert_text_here

Summary Paragraph

Start with the city, media outlet, and your proposed launch date. Give a summary of the product and the benefit. (2-4 sentences)

Insert_text_here

Problem Paragraph

*This is where you describe the problem that your product is designed to solve.
Make sure that you write this paragraph from the customer's point of view. (2-4 sentences)*

Insert_text_here

Solution Paragraph(s)

Describe your product in some detail and how it simply and easily solves the customer's problem. (2-4 sentences, but for more complex products, you may need more than one paragraph.)

Insert_text_here

Quotes & Getting Started

Add one quote from you or your company's spokesperson and a second quote from a hypothetical customer in which they describe the benefit they are getting from using your new product. Describe how easy it is to get started, and provide a link to your website where customers can get more information and get started. (1-3 sentences)

Internal quote

"Add_quote_here"

Customer quote

"Add_quote_here"

Getting started

Describe how to start using this product/feature. (1-3 sentences)

Insert_text_here

Additional Notes on using the template above:

- Title - This is a standard press release title. I like this general format: [COMPANY] ANNOUNCES [SERVICE | TECHNOLOGY | TOOL] TO ENABLE [CUSTOMER SEGMENT] TO [BENEFIT STATEMENT]. You can browse company investor relation websites to get other examples of press release titles and subtitles.
- Subtitle - The subtitle just frames the main announcement in a different way or provides another element of detail.

- Date - This is the date you could potentially launch the product. Safety tip: If you add a date and then review your press release with an exec, they're likely to cache this date and think the product is going to actually ship on the date. Make it practical, just in case.
- Intro paragraph - Provide a crisp 3-4 sentences that reiterate and expand on the title with a little more detail on the customers served and what is being launched.
- Problem paragraph - Lay out the top 3-4 (max) problems for the customers your product or service is intended to serve. Describe each problem briefly and talk about the negative impact of it. Resist the temptation to start talking about your solution. Keep this paragraph focused on the problems, and make sure the problems are ranked in descending order of how painful they are.
- Solution paragraph - Describe how your product/service elegantly solves the problem. Give a brief overview of how it works, and then go through and talk about how it solves each problem you listed above.
- Quote by leader in your company - Pick a leader in your company and make up a quote that talks about why the company decided to tackle this problem and (at a high-level) how the solution solves it.
- How the product/service works - Describe what a customer has to do to start using the product/service and how it works. Go into enough detail to give them confidence it actually solves the problem.

- Customer quote - Create a fake quote by a fake customer, but one that sounds like it could be real. The customer should describe her pain point or the goal she needs to accomplish, and then how the product you launched enables her to do so.
- How to get started - Provide a URL or other information on the first place a customer should go to get access to the product/service.